tournament. My suggestion was to lose 3 kilos each and become a fitter side in the process.

I kept my promise and in fact lost 3.8 kilos. Some of my team-mates did so as well. To do this I had to watch my diet and was on salads after returning to Mumbai. I underwent a rigorous rehabilitation programme on my hamstring under the watchful eyes of Patrick Farhat, physio of the Mumbai Indians, and also hit the gym regularly to strengthen my upper body. The World Cup was promising to be the biggest tournament of my life. It was the one title that had eluded me and there was a good chance it would be my last crack at becoming a world champion – and on home soil too.

India in Bangladesh 2010

1st Test. Chittagong. 17–21 January 2010

India 243 (**SR Tendulkar 105***, V Sehwag 52; S Al-Hasan 5–62, S Hossain 5–71) and 413–8 dec (G Gambhir 116, VVS Laxman 69*, A Mishra 50, **SR Tendulkar 16**; Mahmudullah 2–52)

Bangladesh 242 (Mahmudullah 69, M Rahim 44; Z Khan 3–54, A Mishra 3–66) and 301 (M Rahim 101, T Iqbal 52; A Mishra 4–92, I Sharma 3–48)

India won by 113 runs

2nd Test. Dhaka. 24–27 January 2010

Bangladesh 233 (Mahmudullah 96*, M Ashraful 39; I Sharma 4–66, Z Khan 3–62) and 312 (T Iqbal 151, J Siddique 55, S Hossain 40; Z Khan 7–87)

India 544–8 dec (**SR Tendulkar 143**, R Dravid 111, MS Dhoni 89, G Gambhir 68, V Sehwag 56; S Islam 3–86) and 2–0

India won by 10 wickets

Indian won the series 2–0

South Africa in India 2010

1st Test. Nagpur. 6–9 February 2010

South Africa 558–6 dec (HM Amla 253*, JH Kallis 173, AB de Villiers 53; Z Khan 3–96)

India 233 (V Sehwag 109, S Badrinath 56, **SR Tendulkar 7**; DW Steyn 7–51) and 319 (f/o) (**SR Tendulkar 100**, H Singh 39; DW Steyn 3–